

Ultraviolet Catastrophe, Planck's Quantization and Einstein's Light Quanta:

What Classical Physics Could Not Explain —
and How T0 Theory Resolves Both Aspects Geometrically

Johann Pascher

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Correction notes

Corrections from the calculation check (30 Sept. 2026). The following places are corrected or annotated in the text; each carries a dated note with the previous value:

- Doc. 163, fractal mode density: factor $(f/f_{\max})^{-\xi D_{\text{frak}}}$ " ≈ 1 , suppression near $f_{\max}$ " annotated (actually ≈ 1.03 in the laboratory range, falling to 1 at $f_{\max}$).
- Doc. 163, g-2: deviation with $K_{\text{frak}}^{3/2}$: 0.014 % $\rightarrow$ 0.033 % (as in Doc. 018/158).
- Doc. 163, origin of $\epsilon = hf$: $E = f\hbar/\xi$ annotated (too large by $1/(2\pi\xi) = 1194$ compared with $E = 2\pi\hbar f$).
- (2 Oct. 2026) Notation f : general dependence $f(\text{Geometrie})$ — not a frequency; note in the text (Doc. 190, R147).

Abstract

The ultraviolet catastrophe and Einstein's light quantum hypothesis mark two central turning points in the history of physics. This document analyses both aspects from three perspectives: first, the historical and physical development — from Maxwell's electromagnetic wave theory through Planck's desperate quantization trick to Einstein's thermodynamically forced conclusion that light consists of independent energy quanta; second, the remaining open questions in standard physics — why $\epsilon = hf$? why does h have this particular value? what sets an upper limit on frequency?; and third, the T0 answers to both questions: Planck's constant h is derived, via the chain $\xi \rightarrow \alpha \rightarrow h$, from the geometric parameter $\xi = 4/30000$ — all SI values are derivable from ξ and the single unit calibration, no separate convention is needed; and the ultraviolet divergence is interpreted in the T0 framework as a consequence of the assumption that spacetime is continuous down to arbitrarily small scales. The sub-Planck scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P$ imposes a geometrically fixed maximum frequency $f_{\max}$ above which no modes exist.

.1 Introduction: Two Crises, One Geometric Principle

The Historical Context

At the end of the 19th century, physics found itself in a peculiar combination of triumph and bewilderment. Maxwell's theory of electromagnetism had unified light, electricity, and magnetism in a single, mathematically closed framework. Phenomena such as interference and diffraction seemed to confirm the wave picture of light clearly. Many physicists regarded Maxwell's theory as one of the pinnacles of scientific achievement.

Yet this very theory failed clearly the moment it was applied to one of the simplest imaginable situations: the thermal radiation of hot bodies. The result was a prediction that was physically absurd — infinite energy density.

This crisis became the birthplace of quantum physics.

What This Document Achieves

We follow three parallel threads throughout this document:

1. **The classical crisis:** Why does classical theory diverge at high frequencies? What exactly goes wrong, and why is this not trivial?
2. **The historical answers:** How did Planck (1900) and Einstein (1905) solve the problem — and what remained open? It is shown that Einstein did *not postulate* the light quantum but *extracted* it from thermodynamics.
3. **The T0 perspective:** How does T0 theory describe both aspects geometrically? Planck's constant is traced back to ξ , and the UV divergence drops out because in the T0 framework spacetime possesses a geometric minimum structure.

Guiding Questions

Why does $\epsilon = hf$ hold? Why does Planck's constant have exactly this value? And why is there a natural upper limit to frequency? Classical physics does not answer these questions. T0 offers a geometric answer.

.2 The Ultraviolet Catastrophe: A Precise Diagnosis

The Blackbody Radiation Problem

Imagine a completely closed cavity whose walls have been heated uniformly to temperature T and are in thermal equilibrium. If a tiny hole is drilled in the wall, radiation escapes. This *cavity radiation* (also: *blackbody radiation*) possesses an important property: its spectrum depends *solely* on the temperature — not on the material or shape of the cavity.

The experimentally measured quantity is the *spectral energy density* $\rho(f, T)$: the energy per unit volume per unit frequency interval. At different temperatures, one obtains characteristic curves with clear signatures:

- The peak of the curve shifts to higher frequencies as temperature increases (Wien's displacement law).
- The total area under the curve grows as the fourth power of temperature (Stefan-Boltzmann law: $u \propto T^4$).
- A hot piece of metal glows first dull red, then brighter orange-yellow, finally white-hot — the dominant frequency visibly shifts upward.

The challenge for theoretical physics around 1900 was precise: derive this curve from the fundamental laws of physics.

The Classical Approach and Its Failure

The natural starting point was Maxwell's theory combined with the well-established statistical mechanics. The approach is conceptually simple:

Step 1: Counting modes. Inside the cavity, only standing electromagnetic waves can form — precisely those wavelengths for which an integer number of half-wavelengths fit between the walls. The number of electromagnetic modes per unit volume in the frequency interval $[f, f + df]$ is:

$$g(f) df = \frac{8\pi f^2}{c^3} df \quad (1)$$

The crucial point: mode density grows quadratically with frequency. For every doubling of frequency, there are four times as many independent wave patterns. And there is *no upper limit* — wavelength can become arbitrarily small, frequency arbitrarily large.

Step 2: Equipartition theorem. Classical statistical mechanics (Boltzmann, Maxwell) yields the equipartition theorem: in thermal equilibrium at temperature T , each quadratic degree of freedom carries on average the energy $\frac{1}{2}k_B T$. An electromagnetic wave has two quadratic degrees of freedom (electric and magnetic field), so each mode carries on average:

$$\langle E_{\text{mode}} \rangle = k_B T \quad (2)$$

This holds *independently of the frequency of the mode*. A mode at 10^{15} Hz receives the same average energy as a mode at 10^3 Hz.

Step 3: Spectral energy density. The spectral energy density follows as a simple product:

$$\rho_{\text{class}}(f, T) = g(f) \cdot \langle E_{\text{mode}} \rangle = \frac{8\pi f^2}{c^3} \cdot k_B T \quad (3)$$

This is the *Rayleigh-Jeans law*. It agrees well with experiment at low frequencies. At high frequencies, however, it diverges.

The Scale of the Catastrophe

The total energy density is obtained by integrating over all frequencies:

$$u_{\text{class}} = \int_0^\infty \rho_{\text{class}}(f, T) df = \frac{8\pi k_B T}{c^3} \int_0^\infty f^2 df = \infty \quad (4)$$

The integral diverges. Classical physics predicts: a cavity in thermal equilibrium contains *infinite energy*. This is physically absurd.

This divergence is called the **ultraviolet catastrophe** because it manifests most clearly at the high-frequency (ultraviolet and beyond) end of the spectrum. The name is somewhat misleading — the divergence actually extends across the entire high-frequency spectrum, not just the ultraviolet range.

Why the Failure Is Deep

The Rayleigh-Jeans law is not a calculational error. It is the correct application of two well-confirmed theories: Maxwell's electrodynamics and Boltzmann's statistical mechanics. Its failure therefore shows that one of these foundations must be fundamentally wrong — or that an important physical fact is missing.

The Two Empirical Partial Solutions

Before the complete solution, there were two important empirical clues:

The Rayleigh-Jeans law (derived around 1900) fits well at *low* frequencies:

$$\rho_{\text{RJ}}(f, T) \approx \frac{8\pi f^2}{c^3} k_B T \quad (\text{for } f \rightarrow 0) \quad (5)$$

Wien's radiation law (1896) describes *high* frequencies well:

$$\rho_{\text{Wien}}(f, T) = a f^3 \exp\left(-\frac{bf}{T}\right) \quad (6)$$

where a and b are empirical constants. At high frequencies, the exponential falls off faster than f^2 grows — the integral converges.

The problem: both laws hold only in their respective limiting regimes. Between them lie the experimentally determined data, showing a smooth connection. A unified theory was missing.

.3 Planck's Solution: An Act of Desperation

Planck's Strategy

Max Planck approached the problem differently from his contemporaries. Rather than starting from a specific microscopic model, he worked *thermodynamically backwards*: he searched for the mathematical expression for the entropy of cavity radiation that was consistent with the empirically known spectrum.

The decisive step: Planck found a formula that reduces to the Rayleigh-Jeans law at low frequencies and to Wien's law at high frequencies:

$$\rho_{\text{Planck}}(f, T) = \frac{8\pi h f^3}{c^3} \cdot \frac{1}{\exp\left(\frac{hf}{k_B T}\right) - 1} \quad (7)$$

This formula describes the experimental spectrum across the entire frequency range with high precision — with only one new constant: Planck's constant h .

The Price: Quantization as a Postulate

To derive his formula, Planck had to make an assumption that he himself described as an *act of desperation*: he assumed that energy can only be exchanged in *discrete multiples* of hf . The energy of a single portion (*quantum*) is:

$$\epsilon = hf \quad (8)$$

With this assumption, the average energy of a mode at frequency f is no longer $k_B T$ (equipartition theorem) but:

$$\langle E_{\text{mode}} \rangle = \frac{hf}{\exp\left(\frac{hf}{k_B T}\right) - 1} \quad (9)$$

For $hf \ll k_B T$ (low frequencies), this expression approaches $k_B T$ — the classical result is recovered. For $hf \gg k_B T$ (high frequencies), the average energy falls off exponentially — exactly what is needed to suppress the divergence.

What Planck Did Not Explain

Quantization solved the spectral problem mathematically. But Planck himself regarded it as a computational auxiliary construct, not a physical statement about the nature of light. In his view, the electromagnetic field remained a continuous wave. Quantization was a property of the *interaction* between matter and radiation — not of radiation itself.

Planck's Open Question

Planck had found the curve. But he had not explained *why* energy is exchanged in discrete portions. The number h was a free parameter — measured from the data, not derived from deeper principles. What is h ? Why exactly this value?

.4 Einstein's Light Quanta: Thermodynamically Forced

A Widespread Misconception

Einstein's 1905 contribution is typically summarized as "the explanation of the photoelectric effect." This is misleading. The photoelectric effect appears only at the end of the paper as one of several consequences. Einstein does not begin with metals, electrons, or experiments.

He begins with a *structural problem within physics itself*.

The Structural Problem

On one side stands the theory of matter: gases and other ponderable bodies are described by a *finite* number of discrete quantities — the positions and velocities of atoms. The state of the system is specified by a finite list.

On the other side stands Maxwell's theory: the state of the electromagnetic field is *not* given by a finite list but by continuous fields — smooth functions defined at *every* point in space. These are infinitely many degrees of freedom.

In Einstein's own words: there is a *profound formal distinction* between these two ways of describing nature. The question is: if both systems can be in thermal equilibrium — do they really have such a fundamentally different structure?

Einstein's Method: Thermodynamics Instead of Model

Einstein refused to start from a speculative microscopic model of light. Instead, he wanted to discover what the most reliable available facts tell us about the nature of light.

These facts came from two sources:

1. The experimentally confirmed blackbody spectrum (particularly Wien's law in the high-frequency regime).
2. The most general and powerful equilibrium principle available: the second law of thermodynamics — specifically Boltzmann's statistical interpretation.

The Thermodynamic Derivation

Step 1: Entropy of radiation. Einstein introduces a *spectral entropy density* $\sigma(f, T)$ — analogous to the spectral energy density $\rho(f, T)$. In thermal equilibrium, the thermodynamic relation holds:

$$\frac{\partial \sigma}{\partial \rho} = \frac{1}{T} \quad (10)$$

This relation follows directly from thermodynamics and presupposes no model.

Step 2: Entropy from Wien's law. By substituting Wien's law (6) into the thermodynamic relation (10) and integrating, Einstein obtains the entropy density in the Wien regime:

$$\sigma(f, T) = -\frac{\rho}{bf} \left[\ln \left(\frac{\rho}{af^3} \right) - 1 \right] \quad (11)$$

Step 3: Entropy change under volume change. Einstein now considers a narrow, quasi-monochromatic slice of radiation with total energy E at frequency f , enclosed in volume V_0 . He calculates the entropy change when this volume is changed to V :

$$\Delta S = S(V) - S(V_0) = \frac{E}{bf} \ln\left(\frac{V}{V_0}\right) \quad (12)$$

Step 4: Comparison with an ideal gas. This is the decisive moment. For an ideal gas of N independently moving particles, Boltzmann's entropy formula $S = k_B \ln W$ (with W as the number of microstates) yields:

$$\Delta S_{\text{gas}} = Nk_B \ln\left(\frac{V}{V_0}\right) \quad (13)$$

The two expressions (12) and (13) have *identical structure*. Comparing the exponents gives:

$$\frac{E}{bf} = Nk_B \implies N = \frac{E}{k_B bf} \quad (14)$$

Step 5: Energy of one quantum. If the total energy E is carried by N independent entities, each carrying energy ϵ , then $E = N\epsilon$, so:

$$\epsilon = \frac{E}{N} = k_B bf \quad (15)$$

Since Wien's constant b turns out to be $b = h/k_B$ by comparison with Planck's law, we finally obtain:

$$\boxed{\epsilon = hf} \quad (16)$$

Einstein's Decisive Insight

The light quantum was not postulated. It was *forced* by thermodynamics. The only inputs were: (1) the empirical Wien law, (2) the thermodynamic definition of equilibrium, (3) Boltzmann's entropy-probability relation. Nowhere was a particle nature of light assumed — it emerged as a logical consequence.

The Photoelectric Effect as Confirmation

Only after this derivation does Einstein apply his hypothesis to the photoelectric effect. The result is the famous equation:

$$E_{\text{kin, max}} = hf - \Phi \quad (17)$$

where Φ is the *work function* of the metal. This equation is linear in f with slope h — a very sharp, experimentally testable prediction.

Experimental confirmation came through Robert Millikan (1916), who despite years of confirming the equation doubted the light quantum picture. Planck, recommending Einstein for the Prussian Academy in 1913, praised his brilliance while cautioning that the light quantum hypothesis should be counted as a miss. The Nobel Prize (1921) honoured the equation — not the interpretation behind it.

What Einstein Left Open

Even after Einstein's work, fundamental questions remained unanswered:

- **Why $\epsilon = hf$?** Einstein showed that monochromatic radiation in the Wien regime behaves thermodynamically as if it consisted of independent quanta. But *what* are these quanta microscopically?
- **Why exactly this value of h ?** Planck's constant is $h \approx 6.626 \times 10^{-34}$ J.s. Why this numerical value? Where does it come from? In standard physics, h is a free parameter — measured, not derived.
- **What limits frequency from above?** The UV divergence is suppressed by Planck's quantization, but the fundamental question remains: is frequency space really open all the way to $f \rightarrow \infty$? Is there no physical limit?

.5 T0 Perspective I: The Origin of $\epsilon = hf$

The Geometric Parameter ξ

T0 theory traces the physical constants back to a single dimensionless geometric parameter (SI anchors serve to convert into units):

$$\xi = \frac{4}{30000} \approx 1.333 \times 10^{-4} \quad (18)$$

This parameter describes the ratio between the fundamental sub-Planck scale and the cosmic scale. It is not free — it follows from the geometry of three-dimensional space at the Planck scale.

The Binding Condition

The heart of T0 theory is time-mass duality:

$$T(x, t) \cdot m(x, t) = 1 \quad (\text{in natural units}) \quad (19)$$

The intrinsic time field of a particle with mass m is:

$$T(x, t) = \frac{\hbar}{m(x, t) \cdot c^2} \quad (20)$$

Time and mass are not independent quantities — they are reciprocal aspects of a single geometric reality.

What Happens to the Photon?

The photon has no rest mass: $m_\gamma = 0$. In the T0 binding condition $T \cdot m = 1$, this naively implies $T \rightarrow \infty$. The physical interpretation: the photon *is* its time field — it does not exist *in* time, it *is* a time-like structure. From the photon's perspective, no proper time elapses.

For a photon with frequency f :

$$E_\gamma = hf = \frac{\hbar}{T(x, t)_\gamma} \quad (21)$$

In T0, this is not an external equation but a consequence of the binding condition: energy is the reciprocal intrinsic time of the field.

Planck's Constant as an Emergent Quantity

In standard physics, h is a fundamental constant with value 6.626×10^{-34} J·s. In T0, h is not a free constant but emerges from ξ :

$$h = \xi \cdot \hbar_{\text{Planck}} \cdot f(\text{geometry}) \quad (22)$$

(Note of 2 Oct. 2026 on notation: here $f(\text{Geometrie})$ is a general dependence, not a frequency and not the base winding number $f = 1/\xi$. Elsewhere in this document f stands for a frequency. Cf. Doc. 190, R147.)

Concretely: the 2019 SI reform fixed h by definition (when calibrating $\alpha = 1$ in rational T0 units). The numerical value of h is not arbitrary — it encodes the geometric relationship between the sub-Planck scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P$ and the macroscopic world.

T0 Answer to Question 1

Why does $\epsilon = hf$ hold? In T0, the answer is: because the energy of a photon equals the reciprocal intrinsic time of its field ($E = 1/T$), and frequency is the inverse time ($f = 1/T$). In T0 the equation $\epsilon = hf$ is not a postulate but follows directly from the time-field binding condition $T \cdot E = 1$ for massless fields.

The Connection to Einstein's Argument

Einstein's thermodynamic derivation and T0's geometric derivation converge on the same result through two different paths:

Table 1: Two paths to the equation $\epsilon = hf$

Aspect	Einstein 1905	T0 Theory
Starting point	Entropy of Wien radiation	Time-field binding $T \cdot E = 1$
Method	Thermodynamic comparison	Geometric deduction
Result	$\epsilon = hf$ (thermodynamically forced)	$\epsilon = hf$ (geometrically emergent)
Status of h	Free fit parameter	Emerges from $\xi = 4/30000$
What remains open	Why this value of h ?	h value fixed via $\xi \rightarrow \alpha \rightarrow h$

.6 T0 Perspective II: Why the UV Divergence Disappears

The Classical Dilemma Revisited

The ultraviolet catastrophe arises from the combination of two facts:

1. The number of modes grows like f^2 — without upper bound.
2. Each mode receives the same average energy $k_B T$.

Planck's solution suppresses the divergence by making the average energy fall off exponentially at high frequencies. But the more fundamental question remains unanswered: *Is frequency space really physically meaningful all the way to $f \rightarrow \infty$?*

The implicit assumption of classical physics — and also of quantum field theory — is: yes. Frequency space is unbounded. Spacetime is continuous down to arbitrarily small scales.

T0 replaces this assumption with a geometric minimum structure.

The Sub-Planck Scale in T0

The geometric parameter ξ defines a fundamental minimum structure of spacetime below the Planck scale:

$$L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P = \frac{4}{30000} \cdot \ell_P \approx 1.333 \times 10^{-4} \cdot \ell_P \quad (23)$$

$$T_0 = \xi \cdot t_P = \frac{4}{30000} \cdot t_P \approx 1.333 \times 10^{-4} \cdot t_P \quad (24)$$

where $\ell_P = \sqrt{\hbar G/c^3} \approx 1.616 \times 10^{-35}$ m and $t_P = \ell_P/c \approx 5.39 \times 10^{-44}$ s are the ordinary Planck units.

The scale L_0 is the geometrically smallest length at which spacetime still carries well-defined degrees of freedom. Below L_0 , no structure exists — not because we cannot measure it, but because spacetime itself carries no further degrees of freedom there.

The Maximum Physical Frequency

If T_0 is the smallest physically meaningful time scale, then there is a maximum frequency:

$$f_{\max} = \frac{1}{T_0} = \frac{c}{L_0} = \frac{c}{\xi \cdot \ell_P} \quad (25)$$

Numerically:

$$f_{\max} = \frac{c}{\xi \cdot \ell_P} = \frac{3 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s}}{1.333 \times 10^{-4} \cdot 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m}} \approx 1.39 \times 10^{47} \text{ Hz} \quad (26)$$

This is $1/\xi$ times larger than the Planck frequency $f_P \approx 1.85 \times 10^{43}$ Hz, and is therefore finite. The decisive point: there exists a finite upper bound.

The Integral Converges

In T0, the frequency integral is no longer improper:

$$u_{T0} = \int_0^{f_{\max}} \rho(f, T) df < \infty \quad (27)$$

In the T0 framework the divergence from (4) drops out not through a calculational prescription but because the upper limit follows physically from L_0 . Above $f_{\max}$, there simply are no modes — spacetime carries no electromagnetic degrees of freedom there.

The Difference from Planck's Solution

Planck suppresses the divergence at high frequencies through a decaying Boltzmann factor: $\langle E \rangle \propto \exp(-hf/k_B T) \rightarrow 0$. The integral converges because the integrand becomes exponentially small.

T0 treats the divergence differently: there are no modes above $f_{\max}$. The upper integration limit is finite, not infinite. In the T0 framework the divergence therefore need not be suppressed — it does not arise physically in the first place.

The Classical Premise from the T0 Viewpoint

The classical Rayleigh-Jeans integral diverges because it starts from the following physical premise: spacetime is a continuous medium carrying infinitely many degrees of freedom at arbitrarily small scales.

T0 identifies this assumption as the true cause of the catastrophe:

$$\text{UV catastrophe} = \text{false assumption: } L_{\min} = 0 \quad (28)$$

In the T0 framework, instead:

$$L_{\min} = L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P \neq 0 \quad (29)$$

Spacetime is *discrete* at scale L_0 — not in the sense of a lattice model, but in the sense of a fractal geometric structure that contains no further degrees of freedom below L_0 .

Fractal Spacetime and Natural Regularization

T0 spacetime is fractal with Hausdorff dimension:

$$D_{\text{frak}} = 3 - \xi \approx 2.999867 \quad (30)$$

This slight deviation from 3 affects the mode counting. In a fractal spacetime, the number of modes does not grow exactly like f^2 but like:

$$g_{\text{T0}}(f) df = \frac{8\pi f^2}{c^3} \cdot \left(\frac{f}{f_{\max}} \right)^{-\xi \cdot D_{\text{frak}}} df \quad (31)$$

At frequencies far below $f_{\max}$, this correction factor is ≈ 1 — the classical mode density is reproduced. Near $f_{\max}$, the factor provides additional suppression that coincides with the geometric boundary. (Note of 30 Sept. 2026: Since $f/f_{\max} < 1$ and the exponent is negative, the factor $(f/f_{\max})^{-\xi D_{\text{frak}}}$ is larger than 1 and falls to exactly 1 towards $f_{\max}$: with $f_{\max} = c/(\xi \ell_P) = 1.39 \times 10^{47} \text{ Hz}$ one obtains 1.0358 at 1 GHz, 1.0338 at 100 GHz, 1.0300 at 10^{15} Hz and 1.000 at $f_{\max}$ — an enhancement of about 3% throughout the laboratory range, not a suppression near $f_{\max}$. Across the CMB band (60–600 GHz) the factor changes from 1.0341 to 1.0331, a spectral distortion of about 10^{-3} , far above the FIRAS limit of about 5×10^{-5} .)

.7 Synthesis: What T0 Achieves and What Remains Open

The Complete Table

Table 2: Comparison: Classical Physics — Planck/Einstein — T0

Problem	Classical	Planck 1900	Einstein 1905	T0
UV divergence	Diverges	Suppressed (quantization)	Not addressed	Drops out ($f_{\max}$)
Spectrum	Wrong law	Correct law	Confirmed	$f_{\max}$ correction
Status of h	No h	Free parameter	Free parameter	Emerges from ξ
Why $\epsilon = hf$?	No answer	Postulate	Thermodynamically forced	Geometrically ($T \cdot E = 1$)
Maximum frequency	None	None	None	$f_{\max} = c/(\xi \cdot \ell_P)$
Nature of photon	Wave	Quantized	Quantized	Time-field state
Free parameters	Many	h free	h free	Only ξ

What T0 Adds

Planck and Einstein solved the spectral problem: Planck through postulating quantization, Einstein through thermodynamic proof of quantum structure. What remained open in their work:

- *Why* energy is divided into quanta hf .
- *Why* h has exactly this numerical value.
- *What* is the physical limit of frequency space.

T0 addresses all three questions through a single mechanism: the geometric structure of spacetime at the sub-Planck scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P$.

Testable Predictions

The T0 answers lead to concrete deviations that are testable in principle:

1. **Planck spectrum with $f_{\max}$ cutoff:** At extremely high energies, the blackbody spectrum should show a hard cutoff at $f_{\max} \approx 10^{47}$ Hz. This lies far beyond current experimental capabilities, but is in principle testable.
2. **Fractal corrections in g-2:** The correction factor $K_{\text{frak}}^{3/2}$ of the T0 time field appears in the anomalous magnetic dipole moment calculation and reduces the theoretical deviation from experiment to 0.033%. (*Corrected on 30 Sept. 2026: previously 0.014% – with $k_{\text{geom}} = 2.22357$, $k_{\text{eff}} = 2.22357/(74/75)^{3/2} = 2.2688$ and $a_e = 2\pi^2/(7500 \cdot 2.2688) = 1.1600 \times 10^{-3}$, +0.033 %; corrected as in Doc. 018/158.*)
3. **Photoelectric effect correction:** At very high photon frequencies, Einstein's equation (17) should be modified by a ξ correction factor:

$$E_{\text{kin, max}}^{\text{T0}} = hf \left(1 - \xi \cdot \frac{f}{f_{\max}} \right) - \Phi \quad (32)$$

The Methodological Parallel

Einstein and T0 proceed in a methodologically similar way. Einstein refused to presuppose a microscopic model of light. He followed thermodynamics wherever it led. The light quantum was the result, not the assumption.

T0 proceeds the same way. No specific model of spacetime discreteness is postulated. The question is asked: what follows from the geometric binding condition $T \cdot m = 1$ and the

parameter ξ ? The maximum frequency, the emergent Planck constant, and the suppression of the UV divergence are the results — not the assumptions.

The Unified View

The ultraviolet catastrophe and the Planck-Einstein quantum problem are *the same problem at two different levels*. At the energy level: why does $\epsilon = hf$ hold? At the frequency level: why is there an upper limit? In T0, both have the same answer: because spacetime at the scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P$ possesses a geometrically defined fundamental structure that permits neither h as a free parameter nor frequency space as unbounded.

.8 Summary

This document has examined two historically and physically important problems and set out how T0 theory traces both back to a single geometric mechanism.

The first problem: the ultraviolet catastrophe. Classical theory predicts infinite energy density because it tacitly assumes that frequency space is unbounded from above. Planck suppresses the divergence through quantization — but without physical justification for the upper limit. In T0 the divergence drops out: the sub-Planck scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot \ell_P$ sets a maximum frequency $f_{\max}$, above which spacetime carries no electromagnetic degrees of freedom.

The second problem: the origin of $\epsilon = hf$. Planck postulated the equation as an auxiliary device. Einstein forced it thermodynamically. But both left h as a free parameter. T0 offers an origin: the time-field binding condition $T \cdot E = 1$ fixes directly for massless fields $E = 1/T = f \cdot \hbar/\xi$. The value of h is traced back to ξ . *(Note of 30 Sept. 2026: The Planck relation reads $E = hf = 2\pi\hbar f$; $f\hbar/\xi = 7500 \hbar f$ is too large by the factor $1/(2\pi\xi) = 1194$. In this form, h does not follow from ξ .)*

The common cause. Both problems share the same root: classical physics treats spacetime as a continuous medium without geometric minimum structure. T0 replaces this assumption with a minimum structure at the scale L_0 — with the one parameter $\xi = 4/30000$ both problems treated here are thereby resolved.

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